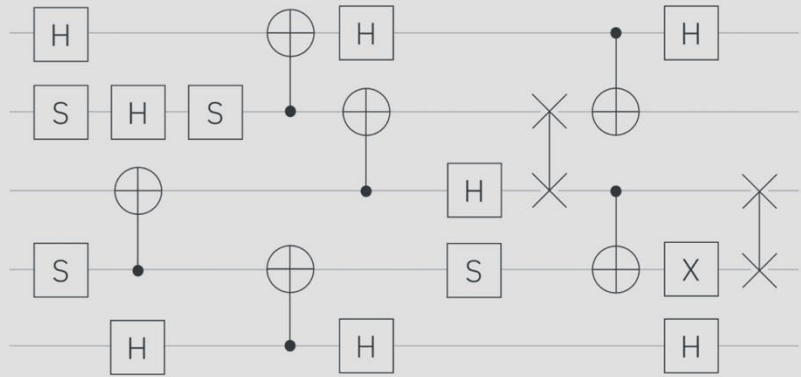




Hello and welcome to the IBM Quantum “Road to Practitioner” (R2P) program!

On behalf of the entire team, we are thrilled for you to join us. Over the next few weeks, we aim to equip you with the skills to program quantum computers using Qiskit for research-level projects. As you have been told, this will be an intensive but very rewarding journey.

Here’s what to expect:

- A weekly lecture, run by [Meltem Tolunay](#), Quantum Algorithm Engineer, and Lead Instructor for Road to Practitioner at IBM Quantum
- Routine assignments and homework to let you apply your learnings using real quantum hardware
- Communications and materials distributed through email, Slack, and Box
- A group capstone project

The first lecture session is on **May 6th, at 1pm ET**, and will be 2.5 hours. Every lecture will be recorded and uploaded to a sharable folder for you to view if you cannot join live. However, please try to join live if you can! It makes a big difference. Most lectures will be 1.5 hours long, but some may go longer.

A few more notes to get you ready to succeed in R2P:

1. **Communications:** All official messages will be sent via email and shared on the [Qiskit Slack](#). We will also use Slack for active Q&A during the program. All lectures, labs, and other materials will be posted in the [public Box folder for R2P](#) (Password: **R2P2026May**). In addition, meeting invites for all the lectures will follow soon. Lectures will be run on Microsoft Teams. If you have problems with any of these platforms, let us know ASAP.
2. **IBM Quantum account:** You must have your account added to your Quantum Innovation Center’s instance for access. Reach out to your QIC’s administrator if you need help. The API token from this access will be required in the Labs.
3. **Qiskit installation:** For most people, [installing Qiskit locally](#) is the easiest choice. However, if you’re unable to, you can still finish the entire R2P program by using a cloud-based platform to run Jupyter notebooks, like [Google Colab](#).

We are looking forward to seeing you soon,

Best regards,
The Road to Practitioner Team